Updated Scholarship Eligibility Report and 2027 Shortlist

Phase 3 verification pass

Version 2.0, 5 November 2026

0. How verified is this report? (read first)

This session's network policy **blocked direct access to every official site** tested:

- africa.engineering.cmu.edu, si.se, universityadmissions.se
- aalto.fi, ntnu.edu, se4gd.eu, cybersure-master.eu
- stipendiumhungaricum.hu, umanitoba.ca, studyinkorea.go.kr, campuschina.org
- ielts.org, ets.org

I therefore verified facts through search results **restricted to each official domain**. These are extracts of the official pages, but I could not open and read the full page myself.

Evidence classes used:

Class	Meaning	Use
E0	Your own primary document (transcript, letters)	Final
E1	Official page opened and read directly	Final (**none possible this session**)
E2	Official-domain extract (search limited to the official site)	Strong, but **re-check on the live page before submitting**
E3	Secondary site (aggregator or news)	Lead only, never final

> **To reach E1:** allow these domains in this environment's network settings (Network access → Allowed domains), or open the links in the Source Register yourself and confirm. I will not call anything "verified" beyond E2 until then.

Your GPA for every test below: CGPA 2.62 / 4.00 (E0).

1. Verification results: priority opportunities

1.1 Sweden: SI Scholarship for Global Professionals (SISGP)

Check	Finding	Class
Ethiopian eligibility	**Yes.** Ethiopia is on the 34-	E2 si.se

Check	Finding	Class
	country list	
GPA requirement	**No SI minimum.** Each Swedish university assesses eligibility and ranks applicants on merit, by its own criteria	E2
Is 2.62 acceptable?	Not barred. Competitiveness depends on the programme's selection method (find out per programme after 13 Nov)	E2 / interpretation
English	**Met without a test.** "Students with a bachelor's degree from Ethiopia meet the English requirement" (English 6)	E2 universityadmissions.se
Degree recognition	Programme must have been ETA (formerly HERQA) accredited during your study years	E2
Work experience	**≥ 3,000 hours before Feb 2027**, from **at most 3 employers**. Employment, freelancing or entrepreneurship all count. Proof on **SI's 2027/28 template, signed by the referee and stamped** by the organisation or a notary	E2 si.se
Leadership	**Required.** Can come from employment, entrepreneurship or civil society; no minimum hours; **strong leadership from employment is prioritised**	E2
Documents	**SI CV template only. A Europass or other format is disqualified.** Max 3 pages. Two reference letters on SI template (one work-based; a second from entrepreneurship or civil society is a merit). Motivation written in the	E2

Check	Finding	Class
	portal. Possible random video. Passport or ID copy. Missing documents mean disqualification.	
Funding	Tuition paid directly to the university each semester; monthly living allowance (SEK 12,000/month confirmed for SI's sister scholarship; SISGP figure to confirm on 13 Nov); one-time **SEK 15,000** travel grant. **SI does not include insurance**; check the university's cover.	E2
Opening / deadline	University round opens **16 Oct 2026** and closes **15 Jan 2027**; fee **SEK 900**, due **1 Feb 2027**. SI templates and eligible-programme list due **13 Nov 2026**. SI portal open **8–24 Feb 2027**, closing **14:59 CET**. Results **22 Apr 2027**.	E2 (dates page may be old; re-check)
Open for 2027?	**Yes**: university round open now	E2
Separate applications?	**Yes, two:** (1) universityadmissions.se (programme admission, by 15 Jan); (2) SI portal (scholarship, 8–24 Feb)	E2
Verdict	**ELIGIBLE (pending proof of hours and leadership on SI forms). PRIORITY A.** This is your best-fit 2027 scholarship.	

Critical dependency: your employers must sign and stamp SI's work-experience form. That makes resolving DR-06 and DR-07 compulsory: the form will show the true dates.

1.2 CMU-Africa MS Information Technology + Mastercard Foundation Scholars Program

Check	Finding	Class
Ethiopian eligibility	**Yes** (citizen of an African	E2 CMU-Africa financial-aid

Check	Finding	Class
	country)	PDF; Mastercard Foundation
GPA requirement	**No cut-off.** "While no cut-offs exist for GPA, most students have graduated with a GPA of 3.0 or above."	E2 CMU-Africa FAQ
Is 2.62 acceptable?	**Yes for eligibility.** Below the typical admit, so essays, the technical test and references must compensate.	E2 / interpretation
English	Must submit **IELTS, TOEFL or the Duolingo English Test (DET)**. Recommended minimums: IELTS 6.5 / TOEFL 81 (the French page says 87) / DET 120. **PTE is not listed.** Waiver only for CMU, US, UK or Canadian degrees, so it does not apply to you.	E2
Technical test	One **1-hour online test** (analytical, quantitative, programming logic), sent after the application is complete. CMU-Africa pays the fee for early applicants.	E2
Work experience	Not required	E2
Mastercard Foundation criteria	Academic talent, **commitment to giving back**, potential to lead. The Foundation lists financial need and an intention to give back. CMU's financial-aid PDF says "disadvantaged background" and **age ≤ 35** for a master's. Priority groups: young women, persons with disabilities, displaced young people. **Admission comes first; admission does not guarantee the scholarship.**	E2 (financial-aid PDF undated)
Funding	Tuition and fees, health insurance, travel, basic living,	E2 / E3

Check	Finding	Class
	project/entrepreneurship support. Tuition for African students 2026–27: **USD 16,000**.	
Application	Three **≤ 300-word** essays plus an optional fourth; **one video essay**; CV; transcripts covering ≥ 3/4 of the degree; **3 recommenders** (contact details; they submit online); no application fee. Plagiarism means denial.	E2
Dates	Opens 1 Oct; **early deadline 15 Dec** (CMU pays the DET fee for first-time early applicants, plus competency test fees); **final 15 Jan**. The site does not label the year; it is inferred as the 2027 intake. Timezone not stated.	E2
Open for 2027?	**Yes** (applications open since 1 Oct)	E2
Separate applications?	Admission first; the scholarship is considered after admission. No separate scholarship form was found (a financial-aid section may exist in the portal; check).	E2
Verdict	**ELIGIBLE FOR ADMISSION. Scholarship depends on demonstrated financial need and leadership. PRIORITY A.** "Fully funded" applies only if you are selected as a Mastercard Foundation Scholar.	

Honesty point: the Mastercard Foundation Scholars Program targets financial need. You must describe your financial situation truthfully. If you can fund part of the cost, say so. CMU-Africa may then consider other aid (other aid tracks are mentioned in its financial-aid PDF but not verified).

1.3 Erasmus Mundus: CYBERSURE (Cybersecurity and Assurance)

Check	Finding	Class
Consortium	Coordinated by **NTNU (Norway)**; 7 universities in Norway, Finland (Aalto), Sweden, Denmark (DTU), Estonia, Austria, France; double degree; **25 places**	E2 ntnu.edu, aalto.fi, dtu.dk
Ethiopian eligibility	Yes (Erasmus Mundus is open worldwide)	E2 erasmus-plus
Degree	Bachelor's in CS/IT/informatics or related, **≥ 180 ECTS or ≥ 3 years** (yours qualifies)	E2 cybersure-master.eu
GPA requirement	"Strong academic record"; **minimum GPA requirements exist but no number is published**. **Previous studies and academic performance are assessed first; only applications meeting those requirements are evaluated further.**	E2
Is 2.62 acceptable?	**Uncertain, and a high risk of failing the first screen.** Ask the consortium before paying for a test.	
English	**IELTS Academic 6.5 with Writing ≥ 6.0**. TOEFL iBT 92 with Writing 22 (tests before 21 Jan 2026), or **4.5 per section** on the new scale. Cambridge C1 Advanced (A–C) or C2 Proficiency. **Ethiopia is not an exempt country; the Duolingo English Test is not listed.** Scores valid 2 years; no combining test dates.	E2
Funding	Full and partial scholarships; the Erasmus Mundus scholarship covers tuition, travel and a monthly	E2

Check	Finding	Class
	allowance	
Dates	**16 Nov 2026 – 5 Jan 2027** (one Aalto page says 4 Jan, so treat **4 Jan** as the deadline); results mid-March 2027	E2
Separate applications?	One online application; scholarship consideration is part of it (confirm in the 2027 call)	E2 / interpretation
Verdict	**ELIGIBILITY UNCERTAIN (academic screen). PRIORITY B.** Apply only if the consortium confirms 2.62 can pass the first screen. Needs an IELTS result by early January.	

1.4 Erasmus Mundus: SE4GD (Software Engineers for Green Deal)

Check	Finding	Class
Consortium	LUT University (Finland), University of L'Aquila (Italy), Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam (Netherlands); triple degree	E2 lut.fi, vu.nl
Application	**One single application** for the programme and the Erasmus Mundus scholarship	E2 lut.fi
Self-funded cost	Participation fee **€9,000/year for Partner-Country students** (€4,500 for Programme Countries)	E2 lut.fi
GPA / English / dates for 2027	**Not found** (se4gd.eu unreachable)	—
Verdict	**ELIGIBILITY UNCERTAIN. PRIORITY B.** Watch se4gd.eu; email the programme.	

1.5 Hungary: Stipendium Hungaricum

Check	Finding	Class
Ethiopian eligibility	**Yes.** Ethiopia (FDRE) is a sending partner; you must be	E2 2026/27 call

Check	Finding	Class
	nominated by the Ethiopian sending partner (Ministry responsible for higher education)	
GPA	Set by each university: entrance exam or interview. Szeged MSc CS: 100-point score (diploma 20, core grades 50, interview 20, extras 10; minimum 50). ELTE: online entry test with a programming task. National scholarship threshold: **56/100** in the institutional ranking.	E2
Is 2.62 acceptable?	**Potentially**, because tests and interviews carry real weight	E2 / interpretation
English	**B2** for most programmes (e.g. IELTS 6.0 at some); per programme	E2
Funding	Tuition-free; **HUF 43,700/month** stipend (the call calls it a *partial* contribution); free dorm **or** HUF 40,000/month for housing; medical insurance. Hungarian-language course required in year 1 or the stipend is withheld.	E2 2026/27 call
Dates	**2027/28 call not yet published.** 2026/27 ran 14 Nov 2025 to 15 Jan 2026 (14:00 CET). Ethiopian sending-partner deadlines may be earlier.	E2
Verdict	**POTENTIALLY ELIGIBLE. NEARLY FULLY FUNDED. PRIORITY B (strong backup).**	

1.6 Korea: GKS Graduate

Check	Finding	Class
Ethiopian eligibility	**Yes.** 2026 Ethiopia quota: **Embassy track 10, University track 13**	E2 et.mofa.go.kr
GPA	**CGPA ≥ 2.64/4.0** for the whole previous degree, or score percentile **≥ 80%**, or **top 20% of class**	E2 (2026 guideline)
Is 2.62 acceptable?	**No, by CGPA.** Only via a registrar letter certifying top-20% class rank, if that is true.	E0 / E2
English	Not mandatory; scores add points	E2
Dates	2026 Ethiopia embassy window: **12 Feb (11:00) – 25 Feb 2026 (18:00 KST)**, online via the Study in Korea portal; documents 11–19 need MoFA consular confirmation. The 2027 notice is not yet published.	E2
Verdict	**INELIGIBLE unless you hold a top-20% rank letter.** Priority B (conditional).	

1.7 China: Chinese Government Scholarship (CSC)

Check	Finding	Class
Ethiopian eligibility	Bilateral programme through the dispatching authority (Ethiopian Ministry of Education); Type B through universities	E2 campuschina.org (general)
GPA	"Academically excellent" bachelor's holder; set by each university	E2
Age	< 35 for a master's (meets)	E2
English	IELTS/TOEFL per university for English-taught programmes	E2
Pre-admission	**A pre-admission letter**	E2

Check	Finding	Class
	from the university is required	
Dates	Application window early January to early April; the dispatching authority sets the exact date. Ethiopia 2027 notice not found.	E2
Verdict	**POTENTIALLY ELIGIBLE. PRIORITY B.**	

1.8 Canada: University of Manitoba MSc Computer Science (thesis)

Check	Finding	Class
GPA	Faculty minimum **3.0 on a 4.5 scale over the last two years (60 credit hours)**; international GPAs calculated on the most recent two years of full-time study	E2 umanitoba.ca
Is 2.62 acceptable?	**Cumulative GPA is not the test.** Your last-two-years performance (about 3.1/4.0, unofficial) must be converted by UM. **Requires university confirmation.**	
English	IELTS Academic 6.5	E2
Funding	All newly admitted CS graduate students are "automatically considered" for support since Sept 2023. The minimum rate (CAD 20,000/yr found in Phase 1) **was cut off in this pass, so re-verify**.	E2 (partial)
Deadline / fee	Fall intake: likely **1 December** (programme table unclear); fee **CAD 130**	E2 (uncertain)
Verdict	**REQUIRES UNIVERSITY CONFIRMATION. PARTIALLY FUNDED. PRIORITY B, time-critical (1 Dec).**	

1.9 Other fully funded technology master's checked this pass

Programme	Mandatory rule	Your status	Class
KAUST MS CS (Saudi Arabia); fellowship automatic for admitted students	**Minimum GPA 3.0/4.0**	**Ineligible**	E2 kaust.edu.sa
MBZUAI MSc (UAE)	**Minimum CGPA 3.0 (some programmes 3.5)**; funding not confirmed in this pass	**Ineligible**	E2 mbzuai.ac.ae
Pan African University (AU)	Master's age limit **25 (men)**; 2026/27 call closed 15 Dec 2025; PAUSTI not admitting master's in 2026	**Ineligible**	E2 au.int
AIMS AMMI	Minimum average about **B or 80%**; 2027 cycle not found	**Likely ineligible**	E2 aimsammi.org
DAAD EPOS	"Far above average (upper third)"	**Likely ineligible** (unless a rank letter says otherwise)	E2 daad.de
Chevening 2028/29	Work 2,800 h; unconditional UK offer; 2027/28 closed 6 Oct 2026	**Eligible next cycle**	E2 chevening.org

2. Alternative pathways for a 2.62 CGPA

Principle: work experience **does not replace** a mandatory academic minimum anywhere in this list. It adds weight where admission is holistic, or where the scholarship explicitly scores professional experience.

Pathway	Where it applies (verified)	How to use it
No GPA cut-off, holistic review	CMU-Africa (E2)	Strong essays, technical test, references, English score
Scholarship that explicitly scores work and leadership	SI SISGP (E2); Chevening 2028 (E2)	Employer-signed proof of hours and leadership
Entrance exam or interview outweighs grades	Stipendium Hungaricum: Szeged scoring, ELTE entry test (E2)	Prepare for programming and maths entrance tests

Pathway	Where it applies (verified)	How to use it
Final-years GPA instead of cumulative	University of Manitoba (last 2 years) (E2)	Registrar certification of later-year grades
Research master's with a funded supervisor	Canadian thesis MSc (Manitoba; Memorial, where admission follows a supervisor's funding offer) (E2 / E3)	Email supervisors with a research interest that matches your operations background
University-specific CSC (Type B)	Chinese universities set their own bar (E2)	Ask target universities for a pre-admission review

Documents that could genuinely help

1. **Registrar class-rank / percentile letter.** It helps only if it is favourable (GKS top 20%; EPOS upper third). If the rank is unfavourable, do not submit it where it is optional.
2. **The grading-scale legend already on your transcript.** It describes C+ and B– as "Good". Your CGPA of 2.62 sits in that band, and you may cite this factually: "2.62 on a scale where 2.5–2.75 is designated 'Good'".
3. **Certified last-two-years GPA.** Useful for Manitoba and any "final years" reviewer.
4. **A short academic explanation** (only where a form invites it, ≤ 150 words). Cover the extension mode, the repeated maths courses, and the final-year 3.05 / 3.35. No hardship you cannot document.

3. Updated 2027 shortlist (ranked)

Strategic score out of 100; **not** a probability of admission.

Rank	Opportunity	Funding class	Eligibility at 2.62	Deadline	Score	Priority
1	**SI Scholarship for Global Professionals (Sweden)**	Fully funded (insurance via university)	Eligible, pending SI forms	15 Jan 2027 (university) / 8–24 Feb (SI)	**85.0**	A
2	**CMU-Africa MSIT + Mastercard Foundation**	Fully funded *if selected*; need-based	Eligible for admission	**15 Dec 2026 (early)** / 15 Jan 2027	**79.5**	A
3	Erasmus	Fully	Uncertain	TBC	71.5	B

Rank	Opportunity	Funding class	Eligibility at 2.62	Deadline	Score	Priority
	Mundus SE4GD	funded *if selected*				
4	CSC China (Type A/B)	Fully funded	Potentially eligible	TBC (Jan–Apr 2027)	70.5	B
5	Stipendium Hungaricum	Nearly fully funded	Potentially eligible	TBC (about mid-Jan 2027)	69.5	B
6	Erasmus Mundus CYBERSURE	Fully funded *if selected*	**Uncertain: academic screen**	**4 Jan 2027**	66.5	B
7	University of Manitoba MSc CS	Partially funded	Requires university confirmation	**about 1 Dec 2026**	61.0	B
8	GKS-G Korea	Fully funded	**Ineligible by CGPA**; rank letter route only	about Feb 2027	59.0	B (conditional)
next cycle	Chevening 2028/29	Fully funded	Eligible	about Oct 2027	77.5	B (2028)

Recommended portfolio for 2027:

Group	Opportunities
Core	Sweden SISGP (2–4 programmes ranked on universityadmissions.se) and CMU-Africa
Backups	Stipendium Hungaricum and CSC
Stretch, only if eligibility is confirmed by email	SE4GD and CYBERSURE
Time-critical optional	Manitoba (only if you can take IELTS before 1 Dec and find a supervisor; otherwise defer)
Next cycle	Chevening and Fulbright for 2028

4. Changes from v1 (5 Nov 2026, Phase 2)

- **CMU-Africa** now carries a financial-need condition, a video essay, a 1-hour technical test, and no PTE. Score 88.5 → 79.5.
- **Sweden SISGP:** max 3 employers; SI templates mandatory; Europass CV disqualified; 14:59 CET close; university round 16 Oct – 15 Jan; SEK 900 fee.

- **CYBERSURE:** academic-performance first screen; IELTS 6.5 / W6.0; no Duolingo English Test; Ethiopia not exempt. Score 77.5 → 66.5; priority A → B.
- **GKS:** 2.62 confirmed below the 2.64 cut-off. Verdict changed to “ineligible unless rank letter”.
- **Added and ruled out:** KAUST, MBZUAI, Pan African University, AMMI.